

The Tiger and the Toad

Good morning, honorable judges, teachers, and friends. Today, I'm going to tell you a story. The title of my story is "The Tiger and the Toad."

One day, a tiger fell into a pit and found he was trapped. He roared and raved, but he could not get out. Just then, a traveler passed by. He felt sorry for the tiger, but he was a little wary of helping such a ferocious animal.

"Just put a branch down into the pit, and I will be able to jump out," said the tiger. "I promise I won't harm you."

So, the traveler did as the tiger asked. Out leapt the tiger, showing his sharp teeth.

"Silly man! I'm hungry now, and my dinner will be ... YOU!" growled the tiger.

"That's not fair!" the man protested. At that moment, a croaky voice was heard from a nearby stone.

It was a toad. "What a noise!" he said. "Show me what exactly happened. I don't understand."

"Well," grunted the tiger, "I was in the pit... like this." He jumped back in. "Only," said the traveler thoughtfully, "this wasn't here then." And he took out the big branch he had placed in the pit.

"I see," said the toad. "Well, I suggest that we leave matters exactly as they are now. Go on your way, my man, and try to think before you act in the future."

"The traveler gratefully hurried off, while the tiger growled and spat in the pit. The toad peered over the edge.

"That's quite enough from you, ungrateful creature," he said. "A promise is a promise, and you must learn to keep yours!"

This story teaches that promises must be kept and that kindness must never be repaid with harm.

-The End-